

SHER BAHADUR DEUBA, 79

Five-time former PM (1995, 2001, 2004, 2017 and 2021) from the Nepali Congress. Was set upon by protesters, as was his wife Arzu Deuba Rana, the foreign minister. Accused of taking commissions in buying aircraft. Rana also linked to the Bhutanese refugee scam.



PUSHPA KAMAL DAHAL PRACHANDA, 70

Four-time ex-PM (2008, 2016, 2022, 2024) from the CPN (MC). Led the armed Maoist struggle (with Baburam Bhattarai), known for his anti-India stand. Accused of diverting UN funds meant for rehabilitating ex-guerrillas. Whereabouts unknown.



RAM CHANDRA POUDEL, 80

President of Nepal since March 2023, called for peace and stability as protests turned violent. Currently in hiding. His office in the Singha Durbar secretariat was burnt down by the protesters.



GEN. ASHOK RAJ SIGDEL, 58

Nepali army chief since Sept. 2024, he put boots on the ground after protests wreaked havoc and secured the airport, parliament and secretariat. Since Sept. 9, had a big hand in stopping further loss of life and property. Has held talks with several Gen Z groups.



SUSHILA KARKI, 73

The first woman chief justice of Nepal's Supreme Court (2016–17), she is the choice of many Gen Z protesters to lead an interim government as caretaker PM. Known for her anti-corruption stand.



BALENDRA SHAH, 35

Mayor of Kathmandu and former rapper, trained as an engineer. He is an opponent of Oli, has publicly called him out as corrupt and supported the Gen Z movement. A favourite to lead the movement or a regime set up by them.



RABI LAMICHHANE, 51

Former deputy PM, chief of the Rastriya Swatantra Party. Was lodged in the Nakkhu jail for alleged corruption, but freed by Gen Z protesters. Seen as a clean alternative to 'corrupt' elder leaders. All 21 RSP MPs have resigned.

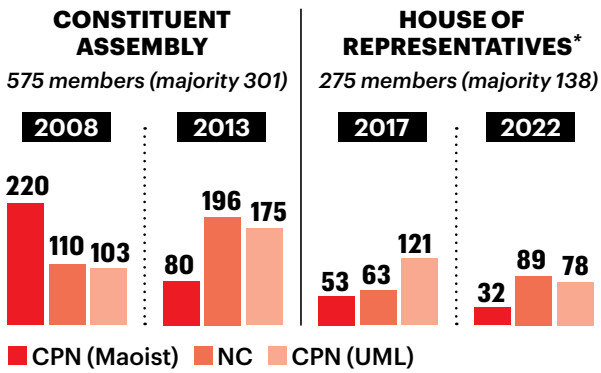


KULMAN GHISING, 54

Former MD of the Nepal Electricity Authority, he's credited with ending the nation's endemic powercuts. He is another popular, 'clean' professional who is now a frontrunner for the job of interim prime minister.

A BITE LESS THAN HALF

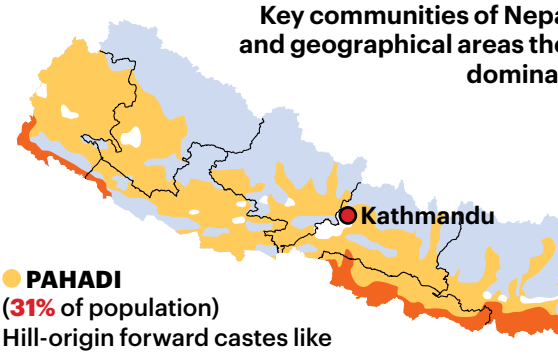
The past four general elections failed to give a majority to any of the three largest parties—the CPN (UML), CPN (Maoist Centre) and the Nepali Congress



**Of 275 seats, 165 members are elected through first-past-the-post system; 110 members elected via party-wise proportional representation*

THE ETHNIC SPREAD

Key communities of Nepal, and geographical areas they dominate



PAHADI (**31%** of population)
Hill-origin forward castes like Brahmin, Chhetri, Thakuri, form the political elite

JANAJATIS (**31%** of population)
Indigenous ethnic people like Gurung, Sherpa, Tamang and Magar, spread across hills and plains

MADHESIS (**28%** of population)
Castes like Kurmi, Bania, Yadav, with close ties to India and staying in Terai lowlands along the border